William Nordhaus



Born in New Mexico in 1941, Nordhaus is a leader in the field of the economics of climate change. He stumbled upon this field of research through sharing an office with a climatologist. Nordhaus's economic theories—the DICE and RICE models—are widely used to analyze policy decisions. Nordhaus is principally concerned with placing a realistic price on carbon. Today, the social cost of carbon is generally agreed to be around $40 per ton, but Nordhaus's models show that it should be higher to account for the impacts of climate change. Nordhaus is Sterling Professor of Economics at Yale University, and serves on the Congressional Budget Office Panel of Economic Experts and the Brooking Panel on Economic Activity. In 2018, Nordhaus was awarded the Nobel Prize in economics.

Key works

1994 *Managing the Global Commons: The Economics of Climate Change*

2000 *Warming the World: Economic Models of Global Warming*

See also: Renewable energy • Man and the Biosphere Programme • Halting climate change

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